dated AH 711/1311 CE). See esp. Dodd and Khairallah 1981: 2:5. Also Appendix, Afghanistan II.

40. Schlumberger disagreed with dating portions of the South Palace to Shansabani presence, e.g., Hall I's oratory (see below in main text), which he placed during Khwarazm-shahi occupation *c*.1215 (noted by Sourdel-Thomine 1978: 39). In his review of the three-volume publication *Lashkari Bazar* (appearing at last in 1978, after Schlumberger's death), A. D. H. Bivar (1980) also disagreed with Sourdel-Thomine's attribution of Shansabani dates to many parts of the sprawling site. Notably, "in a treatment to be published elsewhere" the reviewer planned to "query … the ascription of the [Bust] Arch to Ghurid times" (Bivar 1980: 386); to my knowledge his proposed re-dating of the monument to the reign of Mahmud Ghaznavi has not yet been published. Dani (2000: 559) also dated the "magnificently decorated arch" to the eleventh century without further argumentation. Due to the current lack of access to the site, and Sourdel-Thomine's analysis being the most thorough to date, her argumentation is broadly followed here (cf. *infra* in main text).
41. Cf. Sourdel-Thomine 1978: 42–45, 63–68. We have already discussed (cf. *supra* in main text) the monumental arch inside Bust's lower enclave (Figures 5.9, 5.12 and 5.13), a newly built rather than renovated structure to which she assigned a later twelfth-century date.
42. Schlumberger 1978: 20.
43. For the dating of the Lashkari Bazar renovations principally to AH 55x/1156–1165 CE, cf. Sourdel-Thomine 1978: 10, 21, 29, 39, 54, 57; also Appendix, Afghanistan VIII: 2. For Ghazna, see esp. Scerrato 1959: 42–52; Scerrato 1962: 267.
44. At Ghazna, some marble fragments datable to the Ghaznavid occupation of the site also carried simple Arabic sayings. See Giunta 2010b: 125; Allegranzi 2015: 27–28. These have to be contextualized, however, within the much longer, sophisticated Persian poetic verses probably gracing the entire interior surface of the palace's large central court. Cf. Appendix, Afghanistan V: 3–5; VIII: 1.
45. Compare the similar configuration of a small oratory ensconced within a large public space at the Saljuq waystation of Robat Sharaf (near Sarakhs, eastern Iran) – cf. Chapter 1.
46. Ball (2020) applied this description to both Ghaznavid and Shansabani architectural decoration, distinguishing it from the more restrained decoration on Saljuq-patronized buildings. Cf. Sourdel-Thomine 1978: 42, 44–45; Appendix, Afghanistan VIII: 4.
47. See Dodd and Khairallah 1981: 2:9–15.
48. As also noted in Chapter 4 (cf. notes), verses 1–3 of the Sura survive only in Cairo: at Mashhad al-Juyushi (AH 477/1085 CE); and the citadel of Salaḥ al-Din (AH 578/1183–1184 CE), and nowhere else in the Islamicate regions. Cf. also Chapter 6; and Appendix, Pakistan II: 1.
49. See Appendix II, Pakistan III; and Chapter 6.
50. See esp. O'Neal 2016b; O'Neal 2020; Chapter 1. It is noteworthy that, despite the Ghaznavid minting of *jitals* at Ghazna and Bust from the reign of